

eclipse

Configuring GCC Source in Eclipse IDE

This article is aimed at developers who need to debug or experiment with the GCC source. The open source Eclipse IDE has some interesting features that enable your GCC source to be easily integrated into Eclipse. So, get started!

Before we start, here is some basic information on the software you may need to implement the steps given here for configuring GCC source in the Eclipse IDE.

- The steps are explained based on my experience of using Eclipse on Windows. However, the same can be achieved on Linux as well.
- For building on Windows, Cygwin must be installed on your system. I assume that you are familiar with the tools required for a GCC build (*gcc*, *gdb*, *make* and the associated libraries) and the GCC build process. To refresh the GCC build basics, visit <http://gcc.gnu.org/install/>
- For this article, I used GCC 4.6.2, but the same steps are applicable to any version.

Steps to configure GCC source in the Eclipse IDE

Step 1: Downloading and installing Eclipse. Get Eclipse from <http://www.eclipse.org/downloads/>, which offers several versions; you can use any for C or C++ development. My favourite, and the one used for this article, is Eclipse Indigo for C/C++ developers, which contains in-built CDT support. Installation is simple: just extract the tar/zip archive to the desired location and start using the contained Eclipse application.

Step 2: Creating a workspace. When you start Eclipse, it will prompt you to select a workspace. Specify any name; I chose to use *Workspace_GCCBuild*.

Step 3: From the Eclipse home screen, click the *Workbench* option, and an empty workspace will be created.